

Unit 3



Exploring the past

Inglés Profesional





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Introduction

In this lesson, we will learn different aspects of English grammar, focusing on past and present tenses. First, we will study the Past Simple, including regular and irregular verbs and the verb "To Be" in the past. We will also learn how to talk about past habits using "used to". Then, we will explore the Past Continuous, which describes actions that were happening at a specific moment in the past. Next, we will focus on the Present Perfect Simple and compare it with the Past Simple to understand when to use each tense.

We will also review prepositions of place to describe locations correctly. Finally, we will practice question tags, which are short questions added at the end of a sentence to confirm information.



3.1.

Past Simple

3.1.1. Past Simple of regular and irregular verbs

We use the Past Simple tense to express an action which is finished. It is usually accompanied by expressions such as ago, when, yesterday, last, dates...

We met at a party in 2000.

We find two types of verbs: regular and irregular verbs.

- > To build affirmative sentences, it is necessary to add the verb -d/ed when the verb is regular. Pay attention to the rules.

- » We usually add -ed.

work → worked	watch → watched
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- » If the verb ends with -e, we add -d.

live → lived	love → loved
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- » If the verb ends with consonant + y, we change -y and we add -ied.

apply → applied	cry → cried
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- » Monosyllabic verbs finishing with a consonant + vowel + consonant, double the last consonant.

stop → stopped	plan → planned
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> But if it is an irregular verb, here is a list with the basic ones:

Irregular verbs					
Infinitive	Past Simple	Past Participle	Infinitive	Past Simple	Past Participle
be	was/were	been	let	let	let
become	became	become	lose	lost	lost
begin	began	begun	make	made	made
bring	brought	brought	meet	met	met
buy	bought	bought	pay	paid	paid
choose	chose	chosen	put	put	put
come	came	come	read	read	read
do	did	done	run	ran	run
drink	drank	drunk	say	said	said
drive	drove	driven	see	saw	seen
eat	ate	eaten	sell	sold	sold
fall	fell	fallen	send	sent	sent
feel	felt	felt	sing	sang	sung
find	found	found	sit	sat	sat
fly	flew	flown	sleep	slept	slept
forget	forgot	forgotten	speak	spoke	spoken
get	got	got	stand	stood	stood
give	gave	given	swim	swam	swum
go	went	gone	take	took	taken
have	had	had	teach	taught	taught
hear	heard	heard	tell	told	told
keep	kept	kept	think	thought	thought
know	knew	known	understand	understood	understood
leave	left	left	wear	wore	worn
lend	lent	lent	write	wrote	written

- > To build negative sentences for both regular and irregular verbs, it is necessary to use the auxiliary verb didn't and the main verb must be in the infinitive.
- > To build interrogative sentences for both regular and irregular verbs, it is necessary to change the order of the sentence using the auxiliary verb did + subject + the main verb in the infinitive.



Example of regular verb formation

Past Simple of regular verbs									
Affirmative			Negative			Interrogative			
I	worked		I	didn't	work	Did	I	work	...?
You			You				you		
He			He				he		
She			She				she		
It			It				it		
We			We				we		
You			You				you		
They			They				they		

Example of irregular verb formation

Past Simple of irregular verbs									
Affirmative			Negative			Interrogative			
I	learnt		I	didn't	learn	Did	I	learn	...?
You			You				you		
He			He				he		
She			She				she		
It			It				it		
We			We				we		
You			You				you		
They			They				they		

Short answer for both irregular and regular verbs

- > Yes, I did.
- > No, I didn't.
- > Yes, he/she/it did.
- > No, he/she/it didn't.
- > Yes, we/they did.
- > No, we/they didn't.



RECUERDA

El **Pasado Simple** se usa para acciones que han finalizado en el pasado. Para formar frases afirmativas, debemos diferenciar entre verbos regulares e irregulares, pero debe usarse el verbo auxiliar del pasado, ya sean oraciones negativas (didn't) u oraciones interrogativas (did) seguido del verbo principal en su forma infinitiva.



3.1.2. Verb To Be in the past tense

We use the past simple of the verb To BE to talk about situations and states in the past.

Were they in the office yesterday? No, they weren't.

Verb To Be in the past		
Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I was	I was not/wasn't	Was I...?
You were	You were not/weren't	Were you ...?
He was	He was not/wasn't	Was he ...?
She was	She was not/wasn't	Was she...?
It was	It was not/wasn't	Was it...?
We were	We were not/weren't	Were we ...?
You were	You were not/weren't	Were you ...?
They were	They were not/weren't	Were they ...?

Short answer:

- > Yes, I was.
- > No, I wasn't.
- > Yes, he/she/it was.
- > No, he/she/it wasn't.
- > Yes, we/they were.
- > No, we/they weren't.



RECUERDA

El verbo To Be se usa para describir estados, características y situaciones en el pasado.

Este verbo utiliza **was** con los pronombres personales I, he, she, it. **Were** es utilizado con los pronombres personales you, we, they. Para formar frases negativas, debemos añadir **not** al verbo (wasn't/weren't). Y para formar frases interrogativas, debemos alterar el orden de la oración, primero irá el verbo y luego el pronombre personal. No olvides que el verbo To Be no necesita de los verbos auxiliares para formar frases negativas o interrogativas.



3.1.3. Used to

We use **used to + infinitive verb** to talk about how things were different in the past. Sometimes, we want to talk about habitual behaviour in the past and to contrast it with behaviour now, which is different in some way.

She used to work in a shop but now she works in a bank.

We form negative and interrogative sentences in the same way as regular verbs. This structure needs the auxiliary verb of the past (**did, didn't**)

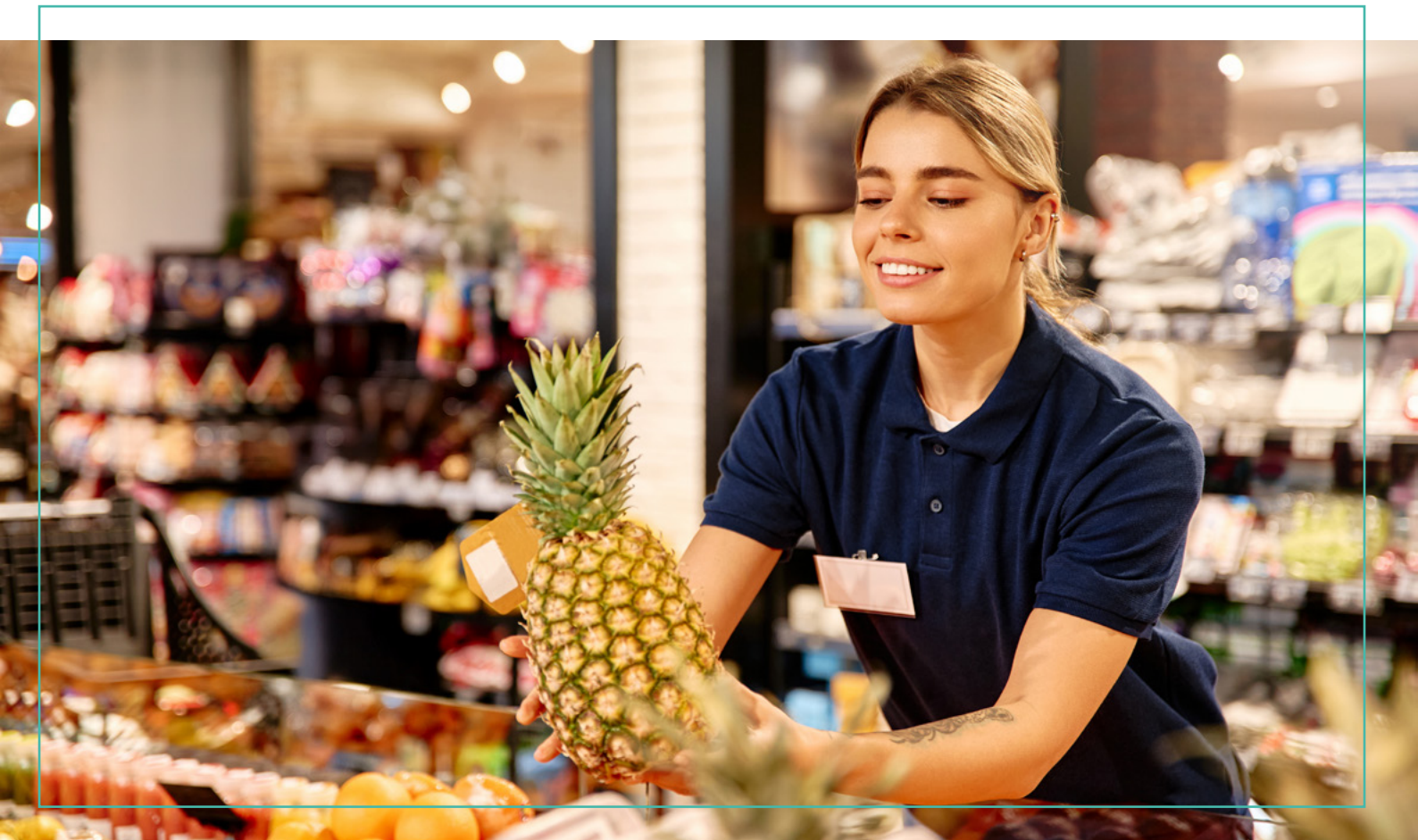
She didn't use to work in an office .

Did she use to work in an office? → Yes, she did.



RECUERDA

El verbo **used to + verbo en infinitivo** se usa para hablar de hábitos o situaciones del pasado que han cambiado. Es un verbo como cualquier otro verbo que para formar frases negativas o interrogativas necesita del verbo auxiliar **didn't** o **did**, seguido del verbo en infinitivo.





3.2.

Past Continuous

We use the Past Continuous tense for a situation or an action which was in progress at a particular time in the past. The Past Continuous tense formula involves the past tense of the verb To Be (was or were) and the main verb in the -ing form.

To Be (was/were) + verb -ing

While I was studying, my friends were playing.

Past Continuous									
Affirmative			Negative			Interrogative			
I	was	working	I	was not/wasn't	working	Was	I	working	...?
You	were		You	were not/weren't		Were	you		
He	was		He	was not/wasn't		Was	he		
She	was		She	was not/wasn't		Was	she		
It	was		It	was not/wasn't		Was	it		
We	were		We	were not/weren't		Were	we		
You	were		You	were not/weren't		Were	you		
They	were		They	were not/weren't		Were	they		

Short answer:

- > Yes, I was.
- > No, I wasn't.
- > Yes, he/she/it was.
- > No, he/she/it wasn't.
- > Yes, we/they were.
- > No, we/they weren't.



To form the gerund of the verbs, you must follow the same rules as we explained in Unit 1, 4.3. Spelling rules for verbs with -ing for the Present Continuous



RECUERDA

El **pasado continuo** es un tiempo verbal que se usa principalmente para describir acciones que estaban en progreso en un momento específico del pasado. Para poder formar este tiempo verbal se necesita del verbo To Be en pasado (was/were) y el verbo principal en gerundio (-ing).



3.3.

Present Perfect Simple

We form the Present Perfect Simple using have or has + past participle. The past participle ends in -ed/-d for regular verbs. For irregular verbs, have a look at the list of irregular verbs. (3.1.1. Past Simple of regular and irregular verbs)

In general, we use this tense when something happened in the past and it has a result now or we do not know when it happened.

*He has lived in the city since 2020.
I've seen this film twice.*

Present Perfect Simple									
Affirmative			Negative			Interrogative			
I	have/'ve	worked	I	have not/ haven't	worked	Have	I	worked	...?
You	have/'ve		You	have not/ haven't		Have	you		
He	has/'s		He	has not/ hasn't		Has	he		
She	has/'s		She	has not/ hasn't		Has	she		
It	has/'s		It	has not/ hasn't		Has	it		
We	have/'ve		We	have not/ haven't		Have	we		
You	have/'ve		You	have not/ haven't		Have	you		
They	have/'ve		They	have not/ haven't		Have	they		





Short answer:

- > Yes, I have.
- > No, I haven't.
- > Yes, he/she/it has.
- > No, he/she/it hasn't.
- > Yes, we/they have.
- > No, we/they haven't.

Present Perfect Simple can be used with:

- > **Ever:** It means "alguna vez". It is possible to use the adverb of frequency "never" but in this case, it expresses experience not frequency.
 - » *Have you **ever** worked in a factory? No, **never**.*
- > **Just:** It means "acabar de".
 - » *She's **just** left the room.*
- > **For and since:** we use these words to indicate time. "For" is used with a period of time and it means "desde hace". "Since" is used for a point in time and it means "desde que y desde".
 - » *I've lived in London **for** three years*
 - » *I've lived in London **since** I was a child.*
- > **Already:** It means "ya" and it is used to express that something happened sooner than we thought.
 - » *A: Please, don't forget to email the document!*
 - » *B: I've **already** done it.*
- > **Yet:** It means "ya" in interrogative sentences and "aún" in negative sentences. Yet goes at the end of the sentence.
 - » *Have you finished **yet**? No, not **yet**.*

There are some expressions or words such as it is the first time... / it is the second time..., recently, today, this evening..., how long...? which are used in this tense.

***It is the second time** she has changed her job this year.*



RECUERDA

El **Present Perfect Simple** se forma con have/has + verbo principal en participio de pasado. Se usa cuando algo ocurrió en el pasado, pero tiene un efecto en el presente o cuando no sabemos exactamente cuándo sucedió. Esta estructura verbal contiene muchas expresiones que definen este tiempo verbal como son ever, never, just, for, since, already, yet, it is the first time, how long o recently.



3.4.

Present Perfect Simple vs Past Simple

The **Past Simple** is used to talk about completed actions that occurred at a definite time in the past.

She broke her glasses yesterday.

The **Present Perfect Simple** is used to talk about past actions that are somehow still relevant in the present in an undefined tense. This tense creates a link between the past and the present, suggesting that a past action is relevant or influential in the present moment.

She has broken her glasses.



RECUERDA

El **Pasado Simple** describe acciones terminadas en un tiempo específico del pasado. El **Presente Perfecto Simple** expresa acciones pasadas con efecto en el presente, sin indicar cuándo ocurrieron.





3.5.

Prepositions of place (at, in, on, under, between, behind, in front of, next to)

We use these prepositions of place to say where people or things are. They go before nouns.

In general, we use:

- > **At** is used when we are talking about a place for a specific activity. We also use **"at"** for addresses or exact positions.

I'm at work.

She lives at 25 Oak Street.

- > **In** is used to talk about a place that is inside a bigger space, such as a box, a house, a city or a country. We also use **"in"** with other physical locations such as: in the world, in water, in the sea, in a river, in a lake, in a pool, in the mountains, in the countryside, in a valley or in the forest.

She is living in London.

- > **On** is used to talk about location on a surface. We also use **"on"** for some means of public transport (bus, plane, train).

The book is on the table.

You can't make phone calls on a plane.

- > **Under** means below something.

The pencil is under the desk.

- > **Between** is used when someone or something is on each side.

Our building is between the cinema and the supermarket.

- > **Behind** means at the back.

Our car is behind the house.

- > **In front of** is used to express a position where you can see it if you look forward.

He was in front of her.

- > **Next to** means beside.

Mary sat next to me in the ceremony.

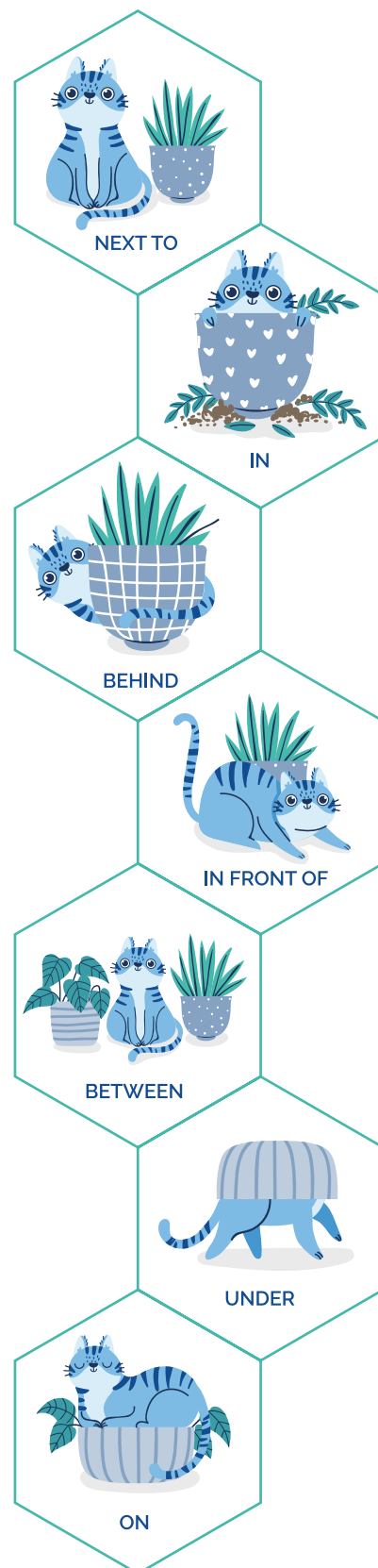


Image 1. Prepositions of place



But notice these prepositions have standard expressions:

Prepositions of place		
At	In	On
at home	in a car	on a bus
at work	in a taxi	on a train
at school	in a helicopter	on a plane
at university	in a boat	on a ship
at college	in a lift	on a bicycle, on a motorbike
at the top	in the newspaper	on a horse, on an elephant
at the bottom	in the sky	on the radio, on TV
at the side	in a row	on the left, on the right
at reception	in a street	on the way



RECUERDA

Las preposiciones de lugar en inglés indican la posición o ubicación de un objeto en relación con otro y se colocan antes de los sustantivos.

- > **At** se usa para referirse a lugares donde se realiza una actividad específica o para direcciones exactas.
- > **In** se emplea para hablar de algo o alguien dentro de un espacio más grande, como una ciudad, un país o lugares físicos como el mar o el bosque.
- > **On** indica ubicación sobre una superficie y también se usa para ciertos medios de transporte público.
- > **Under** significa que algo o alguien está debajo de otra cosa.
- > **Between** se usa cuando hay algo o alguien a cada lado.
- > **Behind** indica que algo o alguien está en la parte trasera.
- > **In front of** expresa que algo o alguien está delante.
- > **Next to** significa que algo o alguien está al lado de otra cosa.





3.6.

Question tags

Question tags are small questions at the end of a sentence. We use them to check information. To make a question tag, we use the auxiliary verb and the subject from the sentence.

- > After a positive sentence, we use a negative question tag.
 - » Example: *Mary will be later, won't she?*
- > After a negative sentence, we use a positive question tag.
 - » Example: *They don't have the notes, do they?*

But there are some exceptions:

- > After **Let's**, the question tag is, **shall we?**
 - » *Let's start with the calls, shall we?*
- > After **I'm**, the question tag is, **aren't I?**
 - » *I'm wrong, aren't I?*
- > After **an imperative** the question tag is, **will you?**
 - » *Don't stay until late, will you?*



RECUERDA

Las question tags son pequeñas preguntas al final de una oración que usamos para confirmar información. Se forman con el verbo auxiliar y el sujeto de la oración. Si la oración es positiva, la question tag es negativa. Si la oración es negativa, la question tag es positiva. Y no olvides que hay 3 excepciones.





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